

ASHISH BHAT

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Staples Inc., Framingham | Software Engineer II - Landing Pages Domain **August 2025 – Present**

- Maintained and enhanced a variety of pages on the Staples' eCommerce website, by implementing features as per business requirements, with a focus on user experience and responsive web design.
- Collaborated with Search and Analytics teams to integrate features like analytics tagging on pages for data enablement, and optimized application performance by identifying and resolving data flow inefficiencies on the server side, leading to reduced latency and faster data retrieval.
- Improved search rankings and increased organic traffic for multiple Staples eCommerce pages by optimizing SEO through targeted code enhancements.
- Designed and deployed a multimodal (text + audio) chatbot using Azure OpenAI and vector search, delivering personalized product recommendations and improving user engagement across the Staples website.
- Onboarded and mentored new team members and interns by delivering knowledge transfer sessions, providing technical guidance, and actively participating in code reviews, enabling them to quickly ramp up and contribute effectively to team projects.

Staples Inc., Framingham | Rotational Software Engineer **June 2023 – July 2025**

- Migrated APIs from Node.js to Java for Staples' search engine optimization (SEO) application in accordance with business requirements, and implemented comprehensive testing strategies, including unit, integration, and end-to-end testing.
- Enhanced the SEO validation application by expanding the test suite, improving test coverage and robustness in detecting SEO inconsistencies across Staples' webpages.
- Collaborated closely with database administrators to develop robust indexing strategies, and demonstrated strong debugging skills to reduce Couchbase queries' response times and improve data retrieval efficiency.
- Integrated Azure services, such as Azure Storage (uploading, downloading, and deleting files) into the SEO application, while developing and maintaining comprehensive documentation about the integrated features.
- Spearheaded the onboarding of a new product content syndication provider, successfully integrating their content into product detail pages to enhance user experience and drive engagement.
- Integrated a new AI chat vendor to replace the existing live chat across the Staples website, enhancing customer support efficiency and improving user interactions.
- Developed a reusable orders status tile, providing users with up-to-date order information and quick access to purchase history, improving usability and reducing navigation friction.

Staples Inc., Framingham | Software Engineer Intern **February 2023 – May 2023**

- Developed an internal pointing poker application, resulting in improved efficiency in the scrum estimation process, eliminating the need for a third-party application, and leading to significant cost savings, enhanced security as well as data privacy for organization data.
- Redesigned the store filter component for the Staples website by adding the functionality for users to select multiple stores within a desired radius, and developed REST APIs for the component using Java and Spring Framework, leading to an improved bounce rate.

EDUCATION

Virginia Tech: Blacksburg, Virginia. **May 2023**
Master of Engineering in Computer Science & Applications **CGPA: 3.93/4.00**

Thadomal Shahani Engineering College (University of Mumbai): Mumbai, India. **June 2021**
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering **CGPA: 8.69/10.00**

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Web Design:** RESTful Web Services (APIs), Spring Boot, JavaScript, Bootstrap, React.js, Node.js, Next.js, Redux.js, Flask, jQuery, XML, PHP, CSS, HTML, HTTP, DOM, AJAX, D3.js, JSON, Sass, CMS.
- **Database Management:** MySQL, MongoDB (NoSQL), N1QL, Couchbase.
- **Programming Languages:** Java, Python, C, R.
- **Others:** Git, Heroku, Tableau, Maven, Postman, Jira, Linux, Windows, Bitbucket, Jenkins, Confluence, Scaled Agile Framework, Pusher, Swagger, Splunk, Microsoft Azure, Apache Kafka, JUnit, Mockito, SonarQube, CI/CD.
- **Artificial Intelligence:** Azure AI Services, OpenAI APIs, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot.

PUBLICATIONS

Bathija Pranav, Chawla Harsh, **Bhat Ashish**, Deshpande Arti (2022) Image Captioning Using Ensemble Model. In: Tuba M., Akashe S., Joshi A. (eds) *ICT Systems and Sustainability*. Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems, vol 321. Springer, Singapore. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-16-5987-4_35